LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH (GR 3–5) INTERMEDIATE: STORY, QUIZ & MUSIC STUDIO

Lesson 4: Scenes and Messages: Telling a Story

Module 2 | 45 minutes | Broadcasts and timing | Grades 3–5 · ages 8–10

Objective: Tell a story in scenes: use broadcast messages so characters take turns, and change backdrops between scenes.

Success criteria

- I can make characters take turns with messages.
- I can change the scene with a broadcast and a backdrop.
- I can plan a story in scenes.

Key vocabulary

- **scene**: A part of a story with its own setting.
- **broadcast**: Send a message to all sprites.
- **receive**: Start a script when a message arrives.
- **dialogue**: Characters talking to each other.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Relay story (5 min): learners stand in a line; each says one sentence of a story only after being tapped on the shoulder (the message).
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	A two-character conversation: learners follow the steps.
14 min	**Perform**	Code Lab: taking turns, Follow the message, Why messages?
9 min	**Probe**	Code Lab: change the scene, activity
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: Write the two blocks that make the Dog reply after the Cat.

Unplugged warm-up

Relay story (5 min): learners stand in a line; each says one sentence of a story only after being tapped on the shoulder (the message).

Teaching the idea

Broadcast messages coordinate sprites: one sprite announces an event and others react. In stories, messages pass turns between characters and trigger scene changes, which is more reliable than matching wait times.

Analogy: A broadcast is like a relay baton: a character can only start when they receive it.

Live demo: Show a two-character conversation using waits only, then change one line's length — it goes out of sync. Rebuild with broadcasts.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Who sends the message and who receives it?	Name both sprites.
What happens if the names don't match?	Nothing — the receiver never starts.
How does the stage know to change?	A sprite (or the stage) receives the scene message and switches backdrop.

Differentiation

Support
Give message names on cards; learners only build the Cat and Dog lines.

Stretch
A three-scene story with a narrator sprite and a backdrop per scene.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Broadcast only goes to one sprite	Every sprite can hear it; those with a matching hat react.
Wait blocks are the best way to sync characters	Messages adapt automatically to line length.
Hidden sprites still talk	Hidden sprites' speech is not visible; show them first.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write the two blocks that make the Dog reply after the Cat.

Homework
Storyboard a 3-scene story: draw each scene and write the message that starts it.

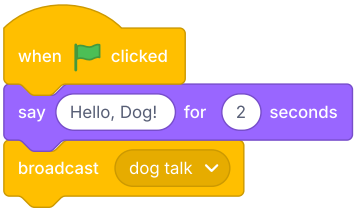
Answer key — Kitabash activities

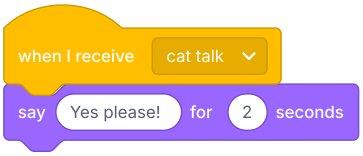
1. Code Lab: taking turns (perform · code lab)

Goals checked: The Cat speaks first, then the Dog · Uses a broadcast · The Dog listens for it

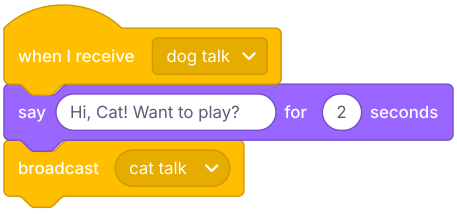
One solution:

Cat





Dog



2. Follow the message (perform · ordering)

Order: The green flag is clicked → The Cat says hello → The Cat broadcasts “dog talk” → The Dog receives “dog talk” → The Dog replies

3. Why messages? (perform · multiple choice)

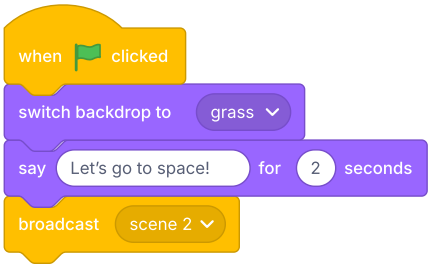
Answer: The Dog always starts exactly when the Cat finishes

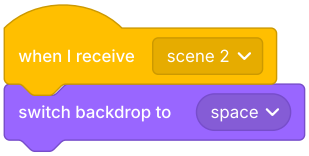
4. Code Lab: change the scene (probe · code lab)

Goals checked: Broadcasts “scene 2” · Ends in space · The Dog appears in scene 2

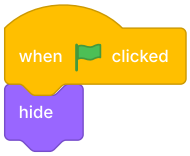
One solution:

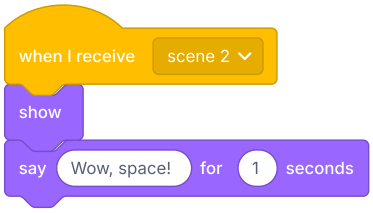
Cat





Dog





5. Explain your thinking (probe · free response)

Look for: scene, broadcast, message. **Example:** Scene 1: a cat finds a map in the park (starts on the green flag). Scene 2: the cat sails to an island (message “island”). Scene 3: the cat finds treasure (message “treasure”).

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** scene = A part of a story with its own setting. · broadcast = Send a message to all sprites. · receive = Start a script when a message arrives. · dialogue = Characters talking to each other.
2. **Plan your code:** Goals: The Cat speaks first, then the Dog; Uses a broadcast; The Dog listens for it.
3. **Follow the message:** 1 The green flag is clicked · 2 The Cat says hello · 3 The Cat broadcasts “dog talk” · 4 The Dog receives “dog talk” · 5 The Dog replies
4. **Why messages?:** A — If you change the Cat’s line, the timing still works — the message is sent when the Cat is done.
5. **Plan your code:** Goals: Broadcasts “scene 2”; Ends in space; The Dog appears in scene 2.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.